CASE-001 | FORENSIC PATHOLOGY

Preliminary Pathology Summary - Prof. Tariq Rafiq

Examination 14 March 2026, 11:30 | Examiner: Dr. Farah Naz (fictional)

DECEASED	Tariq Rafiq, male, 61
FOUND	Rare Books Room, Old Riverside Library, 14 Mar 2026 07:10
CAUSE OF DEATH	Blunt-force injury to the head
ESTIMATED TIME OF DEATH	21:30 - 23:30 on 13 March 2026 (body temperature and rigor at 08:20)

Findings

A single depressed fracture of the left parietal bone, 4.1 cm, with a straight edge and a curved raised rim. The shape is consistent with the base of a heavy brass bookend. A matching dust outline on the shelf beside the body shows that one of a pair of brass bookends is missing from the room.
No defensive injuries. A fresh paper cut on the right index finger and traces of old leather dust under the fingernails, consistent with gripping a leather-bound volume shortly before death.

Toxicology

No alcohol or drugs detected (screen completed 16 March).

Opinion

Death followed a single forceful blow from the front-left by a right-handed person of similar or greater height. The struggle was brief.

FICTIONAL TRAINING DOCUMENT - created for the TRACE X academic project.